

**TRANSCRIPT OF LECTURE DELIVERED ON SUNDAY, DECEMBER 2, 2018
(FORUM 2).**

Topic: The AIMS Scholarship

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Background:

African Institute for Mathematical Sciences (AIMS) was founded by Prof. Neil Turok (A South African) in 2003. The AIMS programme began with a center in South Africa, thereafter, they have succeeded in building an associated network of linked Institutes in some African countries. AIMS currently has six (6) centers across Africa. These include Rwanda, Ghana, South Africa (SA), Senegal, Tanzania, and Cameroon. The idea behind AIMS is to bring talented African Mathematical scientist together with the hope of solving one or more African problems. The first set of students that graduated from AIMS, SA. Before 2012, students were awarded a Diploma degree, but, years after, things have changed. They now award MSc in Mathematical Sciences effective from 2012.

Funding:

AIMS is a Non-governmental Organization that receives funding from host countries like Germany, Canada, and MasterCard.

List of Programmes AIMS offer:

1. **AIMS Master's Degree:** For course work and research work (all centers). Duration is 1 year.
2. **AIMS Mater's Co-operative:** For course work, industrial attachment and a research work (Rwanda, Cameroon and Senegal centers). Duration is 18 months.

3. **AIMS (African) Master's in Machine Intelligence:** Rwanda center only. The duration is 1 year. This is new, the duration is just 1 year and they have started with this first set this year.

Benefit:

- ❖ As at 2016/2017, a sum of 25000 CAD-USD was the worth of the scholarship awarded to each student.
- ❖ Free flight ticket (to and fro).
- ❖ Free accommodation.
- ❖ State-of-the-art facilities.
- ❖ Free Feeding.
- ❖ Free Healthcare.

However, AIMS oversee the spending on accommodation, feeding, etc. so that scholars can only have access to monthly stipends.

Portal: <https://www.nexteinstein.org/apply/aims-structured-masters-degree-application/>

Application Period: Usually from December 1st to March 31st (with possible extension) every year.

Requirement:

Degree or Master's certificate, transcript, referees etc.

Eligibility:

- ❖ Degree or master's certificate
- ❖ Strong academic background in relevant field (second class upper with 70% equivalent can apply).

Important things to note:

- ❖ You are advised to write short essays (note the essays are 500 characters not 500 words)
- ❖ You will need two professors for your recommendation, a Ph.D. holder isn't bad too
- ❖ Avoid referring to the lectures that are to recommend you as Mr., Lecturer I, Lecturer II etc.
- ❖ Early Application is the key.
- ❖ Choose your centers carefully (AIMS has a lot of centers)
- ❖ If you are currently running an MSc/BSc., you can apply. Just that your expected date of graduation should come before the selection committee begins their general evaluation
- ❖ Women are encouraged to apply.
- ❖ Graduates from these areas may apply. Mathematics (Pure, Applied, and Industrial), Statistics, Physics, Engineering related courses, Computer Sciences, Combine degrees like (Mathematics and Economics, Mathematics and Computer etc.).
- ❖ Network with AIMS Alumni, they are very free.
- ❖ Make sure your referees have valid emails. If possible, institutional emails.
- ❖ Finally, ensure you have taken some quantitative courses in your undergraduate's programme.

Questions and Answers:

Q. I have an OND in Statistics and I was admitted to the university to study Statistics through DE. My question is will I be considered for admission? I checked the AIMS website and I saw that one must have had a 4 years undergraduate programme.

A. Yes, you can apply. Provided you have completed (or about to complete) your Bachelor's degrees. Your ND will speak for you.

Q. Please, are we applying for mathematics irrespective of our antecedents?

A. Refer to the list of programs AIMS offer. You can justify your area by selecting courses related to your discipline. Of course, it will be taught. You should also choose a research work in your area.

Q. Thanks. I applied earlier this year, but I wasn't considered. Could it be because I didn't upload my ND transcript?

A. The fact is that, when you are applying, you should display all that you have gotten. It might just be an additional advantage. It will definitely count for you because of the Statistics.

Q. Are the centers peculiar to courses?

A. Yes. But, 70% of the courses will be the same.

Q. Please, which of the centers offer courses peculiar to computer science? I have applied twice but didn't get shortlisted

A. All the centers, I think. You can't survive at AIMS without the computer sciences courses. Almost everything is sciences needs to be automated. Expect a lot of programing modules.

Q. Can someone with economics background apply?

A. AIMS has the option of big data and financial mathematics. So, you can. AIMS Master's Co-op might be okay for you.

Q. Can an Environmental Engineering student apply, because I applied last year and didn't get admission

A. I have friends (Physics graduates) that worked in environmental engineering related area at AIMS. The main thing is that you need to have a way of linking these things together. This should not stop you from looking for other scholarships in your area.

Edited and Compiled by: Scholar Mujeeb Balogun (Cylex) and Scholar Theorem Mavroni

For: The International Scholarship Forum